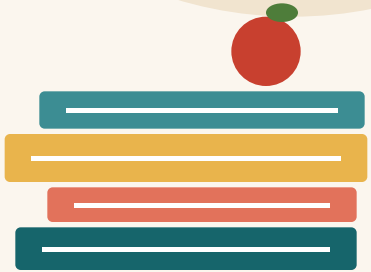
GRANADA MIDDLE SCHOOL

Welcome to 8th Grade ELA!

Ms. Patricia Nguyen | Room 214

Curriculum Night | Thursday, September 17, 2026



A little about me

- This is my ninth year at Granada and my twelfth year teaching.
- B.A. in English from Arizona State, M.Ed. from Northern Arizona University.
- I believe every 8th grader is a reader. Some of them just have not met the right book yet.
- Outside of school: hiking South Mountain early on Saturdays, mystery novels, and two very spoiled cats.



Our class library: 600+ books

What we will read this year

Q1

Identity and belonging

Anchor text
The Outsiders, S. E. Hinton

Writing
Memoir

Q2

Choices and consequences

Anchor text
A Christmas Carol (drama)

Writing
Argument essay

Q3

Voices from history

Anchor text
The Diary of Anne Frank (play)

Writing
Informational writing

Q4

What makes us human

Anchor text
Flowers for Algernon, poetry

Writing
Research project

Plus independent reading all year: students choose their own books from the class library or the school library.

How grades work

50%

Major assessments

Essays, projects and unit exams

35%

Classwork

Annotations, discussions, quick writes

15%

Homework and reading

Reading log, vocabulary, unfinished work

Good to know

- Students may revise one major essay each quarter for a higher score.
- Late work is accepted up to one week late for partial credit.
- Grades are updated in the Parent Portal every Friday.

How I grade writing

Every major essay is scored with the same four-part rubric, so students always know what I am looking for.

What I score	4 Exceeds	3 Meets	2 Approaching	1 Beginning
Ideas and focus A clear claim or controlling idea that stays on topic	○	○	○	○
Organization An introduction, body paragraphs that build, and a real conclusion	○	○	○	○
Evidence Quotes and details from the text, explained in the student's own words	○	○	○	○
Conventions Complete sentences, spelling, punctuation and MLA heading	○	○	○	○

Each essay goes through a draft, peer feedback and one revision before I score it. A 3 means the essay meets the 8th grade standard.

Homework and reading at home

- **Read 20 minutes a night.** Any book counts: novels, graphic novels, sports magazines, books in Spanish.
- **Reading log every Friday.** Five short entries a week. A parent signature is not required, but we love it.
- **Vocabulary.** Ten words every two weeks, with a short quiz on the second Friday.
- **Weekends are free,** unless there is unfinished classwork from the week.

Ask your 8th grader: what are you reading right now, and would you recommend it?

Staying in touch

EMAIL	**pnguyen@cartwrightschools.org** I reply within one school day.
GRADES	**Parent Portal** portal.cartwrightschools.org, updated every Friday afternoon.
OFFICE HOURS	**Tuesdays, 3:45 to 4:15 p.m.** Room 214, no appointment needed.
SCHOOL OFFICE	**(623) 555-0183** Granada Middle School, 3022 N 51st Ave

Dates to know

Mon, Oct 5 to Fri, Oct 9	Fall recess, no school
Fri, Oct 23	Q1 progress reports post in the Parent Portal
Wed, Nov 11	Veterans Day, no school
Dec 21 to Jan 1	Winter break
Spring 2027	AASA state assessments, dates from the district

Thank you for coming!

Please fill out the short "About my student" form so I can get to know your 8th grader. It takes about five minutes and there is a Spanish version.

forms.gle/q7Ngr8ELA2026

Scan me